

JESSICA FAN

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PERSONAL STATEMENT

Bachelor of Science student majoring in Computer Science and Neuroscience at the University of Otago, with interests in data science and full-stack development. I thrive on stepping out of my comfort zone, embracing new challenges, and continuously expanding my skills. I am seeking opportunities that encourage personal and professional growth through continuous learning.

EDUCATION

University of Otago — Dunedin, New Zealand

2023 – May 2026

Bachelor of Science majoring in **Computer Science** and **Neuroscience**

Cumulative GPA: 7.9/9.0

Otago Global Student Exchange Program

- University of British Columbia, Canada
- University of Edinburgh, Scotland

September 2025 - December 2025

January 2026 - May 2026

EXPERIENCE

Data Science Intern, Scentian Bio — Auckland, New Zealand

July 2025 - August 2025

- Rehired on a **return offer** following strong prior performance to deliver focused data engineering and processing tasks.
- Integrated **AI-assisted workflows** to extract experimental data from scientific literature, significantly improving extraction speed and streamlining database integration.
- Built a web interface (JavaScript, HTML, CSS) with a **React** frontend and **Node.js** backend to enable visualisation of database content and user-friendly access.

Bioinformatics Intern, Scentian Bio — Auckland, New Zealand

November 2024 - February 2025

- Developed **Python** automation scripts using **Pandas** within **Anaconda** on **Linux** to transform unstructured data from 130+ research papers into structured Pandas datasets, enabling efficient CSV-to-database ingestion.
- Contributed to the design and implementation of a **PostgreSQL** database schema using **Azure** cloud storage, optimising data storage, retrieval, and CI/CD pipeline maintenance.
- Prepared high-quality datasets for machine learning, computational analysis, and AlphaFold-informed structural modelling of odorant receptor compound similarity.
- Conducted targeted literature reviews on understudied species, compiling pheromone-related information to support research into invasive species-crop interactions.

Class Representative, University of Otago — Dunedin, New Zealand

July 2024 - November 2024

- Served as a class representative for ANAT242.
- Facilitated communication between students and faculty to address student concerns and provide feedback to enhance the learning experience.

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

A Non-Destructive Image Editor (ANDIE)

- Collaborated with a team of 5 to implement a non-destructive image editing software using **Java**, using **Git** and **GitHub** for version control, while maintaining project goals and timelines through effective communication.
- Utilised **Gradle** for build automation and ensured software reliability through extensive testing and debugging.
- Developed core functionalities such as image and colour filters, multilingual support and mouse selection functions.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, Java, JavaScript, SQL, C
Libraries: Pandas, PyTorch, NumPy, Matplotlib, scikit-learn

Developer Tools: Gradle, Git, GitHub, VS Code, Jupyter, Anaconda
Operating Systems: Linux, macOS

ACTIVITIES & ACHIEVEMENTS

University of Otago New Frontiers Entrance Scholarship

2023

Academic Excellence Honour Roll

2024

- Achieved top 5% of students in PSYC111, PSYC211

Clubs & Societies: Otago Computing Students Society (OCSS), Otago Neuroscience Students Association (ONSA), Comp Girls Otago, UBC Varsity Outdoors Club, UBC Surf Club, ESN Edinburgh

In my spare time, I enjoy reading, hiking, and travelling. These interests allow me to explore new environments and appreciate different cultures.

References available upon request